

December 11th 2020 Faculty Meeting

Vikas Berry, [Said Al-Hallaj](#), [Michael Caracotsios](#), Lew Wedgewood, Brian Chaplin, Anh Ngo, Gang Cheng, Ying Liu, Alan Zdunek, Sangil Kim, Betul Bilgin, Shafigh Mehraeen, Christos Takoudis

Minutes passed with Alan Zdunek edits

CREDIT/NONCREDIT

- Discussion of credit & non-credit, a bit unfair for students whose GPA will be affected.
- There can be NO retroactive action, don't change grade on request. Cannot lower their grade to benefit their gpa
- Pete will create a statement regarding policy

Ezinne Achinivu-Faculty Position

- Opportunity hire. Need to diversify in terms of research, culture and gender
- Very clear presentation, shows good aptitude for teaching
- Want to make sure the administration is on the same page as us in hiring someone to achieve tenure
- Technical things not adding up to research/CV and technical questions avoided
- Publications are not there
- Are we making concessions for cultural/gender diversity? Will we then make these concessions when tenure is sought?
- We don't want to lower the bar for people eventually seeking tenure?
- Moving from energy to materials due to funding
- WISEST always makes an effort to have a diverse pool of candidates but the end goal is to hire on Merit. Only when you have equal candidates should you lean to a diverse candidate hire
- Mentoring program should be developed to aid new hires
- Can she be mentored to become successful
- Concerns about research direction and development
- Where is her point of competing with independent laboratories or industry? Where is she able to collaborate? She may need help in developing collaboration and support
- What is the likeliness of us getting a similar candidate as them
- She has a solid understanding and reasoning for questions posed to research
- She's making connections. Holistic vision
- This is not an open search. This hire will come from the chancellor
- No high impact publications, she needs someone to help give her direction
- She still feels very new postdoc
- Anh has 2 diverse candidates that will be sent for review
- She's going to be a good teacher she has the knowledge and vision for it
- Short term research is great but long term is in the air
- **Position for Opportunity Hire:**
 - There is a mentorship program by the college
 - We don't know how long the position will be open

- We have to ask the chancellor for funding before we can make the offer (president's money)
 - Deadline? No because it's not an advertised position
- If we have a mentorship program in mind, would we consider hiring PhD candidates? Yes, but it's hard to attract the ones on our seminar series. It's hard to compete as many of them are "stars"
- Vote on pursuing Hire
 - Aye: IIII
 - Naye: I

Clinical Track Faculty Search

- Alan will chair
- Waiting on college HR approval to move forward

Department Name

- No name change
- # 1 Department of Chemical Engineering & Nanotechnology
- 10 options
- How would it affect our recruitment (undergrad especially), impression on peer departments, student impression
- Department name changes but not their degree
- Nanotechnology is a bit dated. Perhaps Quantum technology?
- Chemical engineering is not clear to undergrads or high school students. What does it mean?
- Nanotechnology is a buzz word for recruitment
- Competing with other departments or universities so we might as well not change
- Marketing & descriptive standpoint
- Perhaps "chemical & molecular engineering"
- Helps our academics but not our recruitment or comprehension
- Perhaps invest in marketing our new tracks and describing what chemical engineering is.
- Civil engineering changed to Civil & Environmental Engineering and they stole some of the students we usually got
- Adding to the name will not hurt
- "Electrochemical" added in
- Chemical Engineering is more easily recognized despite it being initially known as gas and oil

CHE 100

- **CHEME Industry Day**
 - 2/26, 3/5 3/12 possible dates to see if people are having exams
 - Encourage access students

Undergraduate Student Office

- Climate warming course approved

- 301 concurrent curriculum change approved
- 230 add approved
- Said has approved 494 Entrepreneurship as a permanent course:
 - College had a separate course and they filled the gap between the groups
 - 20 students and the quality was incredible
 - Next step to work with faculty to commercialize research developments and make it a senior project (needs a lot of time)
 - Only a fall course
 - Basics accounting, ROI
 - Motion to approve permanency of course
 - The Ayes carry it
- Meenesh has 494 biopharmaceutical... this will also be part of the certificate program
- 494 Clean Energy and the grid from Said in the Spring Interface of energy storage and the smart grid
- Change name of 433
- ABET course surveys and codes have been sent out and faculty should have been received
- 330 course change approval in exchange for p-chem. Modification of major please sign and send to Alan
- Discuss the necessity of the ABET survey to the department

Graduate Student Office

- Started to receive applications for next year. Mainly MS program
- Just 3 phd applications
- 3 students abroad attempting to get visas, tuition will be waived if they still can't come in the spring and TA position offers will be honored when they do come.

February 26, 2021 Faculty Meeting

Vikas, Gang, Michael, Brian, Anh, Sangil, Alan, Lew, Said, Betul, Meenesh, Jan, Christos

Motion to pass the minutes approved

Undergraduate

- March 4th meeting to approve concentration addition
- 125 admitted 10 accepted
- Reaching out to undecided and pending students
- Sent out alumni survey to find out where they are working, salary range, & highest degree
- AIChE outstanding senior McCormack award, thinking of nomination
- All universities are down in Enrollments

Graduate

- 35 MS applications (last year we had 33)
- 29 PhD application (43 last year)
- Last year had 1 African student with Fulbright scholar
- Last semester had 5 students on probation
- Award deadlines are coming up, please encourage students to apply (provost & graduate)

Diversity & Engagement

- Access meeting tomorrow, aiming to have one every 2 weeks
- Freshman engagement (Alan will send out invites from Betul)

Department

- Ezinne offer went out and she has another offer and is going to take time to decide
- Vaccination: pushing to have faculty and staff considered 1B+
 - If you're working on covid-19 research you qualify as first responder
- Post pandemic instruction survey
 - Table of results will be shared
 - Majority of people would like a blended instruction of online and in person
 - Keep videos of recorded lectures and use time to clarify information presented and answering question. Videos + more interactive classes
 - Class attendance/interaction for undergraduate classes
 - 67% on campus to 33% remote
 - Blackboard quizzes will stick around
- Consideration for students traveling to campus, with health concerns, or live with vulnerable
- Survey students on post pandemic return?
- Lockdown browser for remote testing?
- ORS issue
 - Vikas spoke with Pete, Venkat and ORS meeting on Monday
 - Email will be sent after the Monday meeting

- ORS is low staff and attempting to hire
 - ORS feedback page and PAF/contract tracker needed
- Faculty research promotion
 - Use university and college press, utilize David's skills
 - Short videos for each lab about research being done
 - Getting articles written and widely publicized go through UIC PIO then internal is David
- department hosting energy & engineering entrepreneurship education workshop for undergrad. Integrate into our program, college (Said)
- Brian organizing seminar series on Current but looking to promote own institution. Once a month

April 23, 2021 Faculty Meeting

Vikas Berry, Lew Wedgewood, Ying Liu, Anh Ngo, Michael Caracotsios, Said Al-Hallaj, Brian Chaplin, Alan Zdunek, Gang Cheng, Sangil Kim, Meenesh Singh, Betul Bilgin, Vivek Sharma, Christos Takoudis

Motion to approve minutes pass unopposed

Diversity Statement:

“The Department of Chemical Engineering fosters inclusive environment that encourages and supports diverse voices and opinions. We value all forms of diversity within our faculty, staff, and student population. Our multicultural, pluralistic community brings richness in experience, backgrounds, ideas, perspectives, and skills to all activities in the department”

- Remove extra “diversity” to avoid sounding repetitive
- Replace “diverse voice”

Fall Instruction

- All courses will be recorded because not everyone will be able to attend
 - Everything will be recorded white board, projections, simulations, etc.
- Equipment upgrades for classrooms requested and awaiting approval from the college
- Suggestions for more needed equipment? Bluetooth headset/microphone for lecture rooms
- Send requests via email to Vikas
- Will there be an opportunity to review this new setup and training for use of new recording/teaching

GPIP

- 25% TA summer (course Builder)
 - Names? (MS & PHD eligible (not 4+1))
- GPIP 10 freshmen + 2 transfer (+3 remaining from last summer)

- Monday 4/26 is the last day to apply

Coming up

- 5 concentrations will be available soon
 - Courses to be re-determined for Spring 2022
 - Expected 2 course: adjuncts or Overcompensations
 - Accepting suggestions for adjuncts or volunteers
 - Teaching Assistantship/Fellowship opportunity
- MS in Molecular and Nanoscale Engineering (target Fall 2022)
 - Program draft to be prepared over summer
 - Leveraging the courses from the concentrations
 - Towards molecular engineering
 - Anh, Lew & Vivek offering to teach courses
- CHE 101 Planning over the summer
 - Betul offered to help with planning

Admissions

- Numbers up from 2020 but not compared to 2019

Potential New Faculty Member

Ursula Perez-Salas

- Currently Assistant professor in Physics
- NSF CAREER Awardee and expecting NIH grant
- Molecular Transport in Biological Membrane
- Associate Professor at hiring (Q-position 3-4 years) tenure track, teaching and research
- Why didn't she get tenure? Funding, but she got funded after the process was over
- She is a PhD in chemical technology
- Because of centralized budget (based on enrollment) we have to ask for approval and make a case to hire them on
- Opportunity hires can get funding from elsewhere
- CO-I on NIH grant coming up 750K per year for 5 years Not official yet but will be heard about soon
- Soft matter and neutron scattering
- Physics Dept. Head would prefer to keep her at the university
- Guest lectured for Ying and has done a seminar
- She fits well into Molecular and Nanoscale MS teaching
- Family connection to the city
- Invite for Seminar & Research talk
- Motion to move forward: Ayes carry it

Publications

- Said surpassed 10K citations, Gang hitting 5600
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Undergraduate

- Recruitment ignite event had 6 students, 2 students decided to attend after
- ABET survey revisions needed
- Baseline of rubric assessments

Graduate

- Annual PhD review
 - Committee should have an annual review meeting to evaluate progress
 - Address issues within 3 months, if they have not after 3 months they will be put on probation
 - At next review if they have not made progress advisor can drop them and/or rescind financial support, department will give a semester buffer (25% TA or tuition fee waiver) to improve and find new advisor
- Choose permanent advisor 1st year
 - Second semester if they don't have one yet they get written warning
 - 3rd semester put on probations
 - 4th semester dismissed
- Thesis committee created in 1st year
- Prelim deadline requirement? Have date before the end of their second year

Graduation

- Commencement day being brought to courtyard to do small celebrations
- Virtual celebration

Diversity & Inclusions

- Training/workshop during graduate orientation
- Betul now part of the college level diversity committee
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Friday 4/30/21 at 4pm Provost meeting for annual review of Dean Nelson. Any comments or issues email Lew Wedgewood

FACULTY MEETING June 16th 2021

Vikas, Anh, Meenesh, Michael, Lew, Brian, Said, Shafigh, Christos, Ying, Sangil

University approval for international travel necessary for cyber security

Motion to approve minutes: Motion approved

Enrollment

62 ITEs and courting undecided engineering, women and minority numbers going up

Admissions up, but applications are down

Perez-Salas Case

- Chancellor suspended diversity recruitment program, hopefully the new provost will bring it back.
- We did have support from the interim provost.
- Hire looks uncertain. Working on Proforma with college to see if we can make a case for her hire

Undergraduate Report: Faculty Meeting, June 16, 2021

1. Spring Admissions and summer activities:
 1. CHE Accepted: 62
 2. CHE Deferred: 3
 3. COE Undeclared Accepted: 148
 4. Planning in-person incoming student orientation events in July and August
 1. Inside EIB (pending UIC approval)
 5. Continuing email blasts to incoming students promoting our department, faculty research and curriculum; also targeting COE Undeclared incoming students to generate interest in ChE major
2. Mathematics, Numerical Methods, and Process Simulation Applications webinar for undergraduates

1. Weekly summer zoom sessions hosted by Michael Caracotsios
2. 3 sessions completed- good interest from students
3. Concentrations: Approved by UIC Board of Trustees- waiting for IBHE approval (end of June)
 1. Advertise concentrations after final approval
4. Updating UG landing webpage on ChE website to include Career info- (David Brazy)

GPIP students will be matched on Monday 6/21

CEB cleaning \$15K to identify and dispose of remaining chemicals

Urgent need for Classroom Equipment for hybrid teaching?

- Training?
- 2 additional TAs for streaming class
- 3 ft distance possible starting in Fall

Student mentoring program committee to advise on move from graduate student to academia

- Committee: Meenesh Singh, Betul Bilgin, Brian Chaplin, & Ying Liu
- 1 year duration, seminars, teaching opportunities

ACCESS

- Forming student committee
- Trouble getting speakers

Add diversity training into orientation

Entrepreneurial endeavor to buffer between research and industrial. A prototype company

Entrepreneur meeting hosted by Said

Faculty Meeting July 2021 Minutes

Vikas, Alan, Betul, Michael, Said, Anh, Ezinne, Meenesh, Sangil, Shafigh, Lew, Ying, Brian

Minutes Approved

5 new concentrations are officially approved

Funding acknowledgements in papers: acknowledge appropriately; over acknowledge is necessary

All proposals (except white papers) need to go through ORS

FALL 2021

- Students vaccinated can attend in person
- International student vaccination on arrival
- Vaccinated= no need for saliva testing
- Faculty need to report vaccination status by August 1st → no need for saliva testing & quarantining after contact or travel
- Teaching on campus with online streaming content. Exams on Campus
- Student/people unvaccinated due to medical conditions must wear a mask
- Social distancing may be relaxed soon
- Mask in EIB will remain
- TA to aid in streaming is needed

Undergrad

- BA comparable to years before
- MS 29+7=36
 - 4+1 Program =22 (7+15)
 - Regular MS= 14
- PHD admissions= 6
 - Uptick in international application coming back

Grant Expenditures: 1.5 million above 1.3 mill of last year

Publication Data doing well

Teaching evaluation numbers impacted by COVID but numbers are still strong

CHE Entrepreneurs Club:

- Series of lectures will start today (today is about licensing, etc)

CHE Professional Development Program

- Gauge student interest & needs to include in program
- Professional development with possibility of apprenticeship

- Casual meeting, club style

Undergraduate orientation: Work with students on enrolling in classes on Wednesday, talk about the program, student AIChE rep.

Lab & Building safety: Students not wearing masks, but they are still required in EIB; complaint box; banning/restricting access if mask is not worn

Connectivity/Return to campus: staff will be in for 2-3 days a week, an increased use of MS teams to connect with Chemical Engineering team

Retreat Planning underway: after august 14th

Ursula Perez-Salas: Pete is reviewing it again; Berry has submitted a financial plan that needs college and university approval

Undergrad

Michael has been hosting webinars

Mixed remote/in-person work and response from alums & advisory committee

New flow chart

Diversity & engagement: Students are less engaged this summer, they seem overwhelmed, Brian WEF program to engage minorities

Shafigh & Meenesh can send proposals to professors ASAP for review

Wedgewood: search committee for associate director for research

CHEME car program has stalled, and no one has approved funding

Lecture streaming training will be set up once software is set up

FACT Computers are every 5 years and they are college regulated with specific configurations. Jan has list of computers, Roberto will approve/fund, Sarai will order

SAXENA distinguished lecturer will come April 22, 2022 Pablo D.

Faculty meeting will continue to be virtual